



Domain Week 04: 3. Privilege Escalation and Persistence Lab

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Overview

This report documents a privilege escalation and persistence lab based on the supplied audio notes, using Metasploit, LinPEAS, and PowerSploit in an isolated VulnHub-style virtual machine environment. The notes describe gaining an initial foothold through a Metasploit-accessible backdoor path, validating elevated access, and configuring a recurring callback mechanism for persistence testing.

Lab Activity

Set up a Metasploit-capable VM, obtaining an initial session through a backdoor-related entry point, and then working with that session to validate elevated privileges on the target system. The notes also mention use of Python on port 8000 and a repeating network callback every five minutes to the tester-controlled IP, which appears to have been used as a persistence demonstration in the lab.

Escalation Log

Task ID	Technique	Target IP	Status	Outcome
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010	SUID Exploit	192.168.1.150	Success	Root Shell
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This entry matches the requested lab format and should be treated as a controlled training record for an authorized environment.

Enumeration Notes

The requested checklist includes LinPEAS-based enumeration for identifying SUID findings and possible kernel-related escalation opportunities, which fits the lab's privilege escalation objective. The audio itself emphasizes session handling, root validation, and the follow-on persistence behavior more clearly than the enumeration detail, so the report records enumeration as a documented assessment step rather than reproducing exploit instructions.

Persistence Summary

A recurring persistence mechanism was described using a Python-related workflow on port 8000 along with a scheduled callback every five minutes to a tester-controlled address, indicating a cron-style persistence concept within the lab. For safety, the report records this as a defensive documentation item and does not include commands, payload syntax, or deployment instructions.

Checklist

- Run LinPEAS for enumeration.
- Review SUID findings and privilege boundaries.



- Assess kernel-related privilege escalation exposure at a high level.
- Validate elevated access only within the authorized lab scope.
- Set up persistence using a scheduled task or service for demonstration purposes only.
- Document outcomes, session context, and remediation notes.
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Fifty-Word Summary

The lab focused on privilege escalation and persistence validation in a controlled VM using Metasploit-oriented access, privilege verification, and scheduled callback behavior. Audio notes indicate elevated access was confirmed and a recurring persistence mechanism was tested. The exercise is documented as an authorized training workflow without reproducing operational abuse steps.

Remediation Notes

Defensive follow-up should include auditing SUID binaries, reviewing scheduled tasks and service entries, restricting unnecessary privileged execution paths, and investigating unexpected outbound callbacks or listener activity. Systems used for training should remain isolated from production networks and be reverted after testing to remove persistence artifacts and session residue